

Automating the booth graphics pipeline

Southeast Exhibits & Events · every issue raised maps to a concrete step. We build it ourselves, in order, proving each step before the next.

Status: **LIVE NOW** built & in hand **BUILDING NEXT** **SEPARATE PROJECT**

THE ISSUE	WHAT WE DO ABOUT IT	STATUS
Uniform templates — "nonnegotiable"	One tool builds every wall/panel identically from a single booth file — same result no matter which 3D designer or software made the booth.	LIVE NOW
Slow 3D turnaround to make templates	Template-building moves off the 3D team — the graphics team generates the whole set in seconds.	LIVE NOW
Inconsistent client spec sheets	The client submission sheet is generated from the same booth file, so it always matches the templates exactly.	LIVE NOW
Walls missed; visible-vs-not, finishes, single/double-sided unclear	Every surface, finish, side, and visible-vs-blocked area is captured once at intake and called out on both the template and the client sheet.	LIVE NOW
Nothing should ever get missed	Intake drafts the booth file from the 3D drawings and flags size disagreements. Even a visual slide-deck handoff is read by OCR, and the AI flags any surface in the render but missing from the key. Anything a person hasn't confirmed is marked "unverified" and can't reach print — no wall slips through, no unconfirmed size ships.	LIVE NOW
AI proofer (spelling, hi/low-res, sizing)	Client files are auto-checked against the booth file — size, resolution, color, fonts, spelling — flagged before a human ever looks, with a one-page report per file plus a plain-English "what to change" list for the client (we never edit their file). ("A 1985 Dell can catch this." Agreed.)	LIVE NOW
Clients submit the wrong size or forget bleed	Optional per-panel design templates — a PDF with the bleed/trim/safe guides drawn on, openable without Illustrator — let clients build on the real layout, cutting wrong-size and no-bleed files at the source.	LIVE NOW
No single view of every job in flight	A job dashboard lists every active job and its stage (intake → awaiting confirm → in proof → approved), the due date, and risk flags (unconfirmed size, failed check, approaching deadline) — built from the booth files + the proof log.	LIVE NOW
Control the proof, not the vendors	A SEE-owned proof to Production's standard — spec block, status legend, disclaimer, 3-way sign-off, and the prepped/QC/fulfillment details (shown once on the cover for a whole job). One page per graphic or a whole-job document . Dated, locked, logged; approval refused on a fail or an unverified size. Vendors get it as a second set of eyes.	LIVE NOW
Clients stall / abuse the proof step; live portal + payment	A hosted portal: client logs in, uploads, the auto-check runs, they sign, it locks by the due date, and reopening requires approval + an add-on charge. A real software product — built last, once the steps above are proven.	SEPARATE

The bottom line

In hand today: intake (drafts the booth file from the 3D handoff — even a visual slide deck, via OCR — flags size conflicts, and marks anything unconfirmed), the uniform template generator, the auto-matched client spec sheet (plus optional per-panel client design templates), the AI proofer (now with a plain-English "what to change" fix list), a SEE-owned proof built to Production's standard — single-item or a whole-job document, with a dated, locked sign-off + tracking log, and a guard so an unverified size can't reach print — and a job dashboard that tracks every job's stage and risk flags. Proven on our build example (Mama's Creations) and on a live job's handoff (Syntron).

Separate funded project, last: the live client portal — clients log in, upload, the auto-check runs, they sign, it locks, paid unlock. It only pays off once the steps above are proven, and needs its own engineering, hosting, and payment setup.

The key insight: uniform templates fix the *format*; making sure nothing is missed and finishes are right is fixed by standardizing what we *capture* up front. We're doing both — that's why this works where past attempts stalled.